

GRANT **FOR** CONGRESS

MESSAGING

Stump Speech

Matt Grant for Congress — Missouri's 2nd District

Stump Speech

A stump speech is the candidate's core 5–7 minute address, repeated until it's second nature. This is a fill-in-the-blanks scaffold: keep the structure, swap in your specifics, and say it the same way every time so the message compounds.

The Arc (5–7 minutes)

1. **Hook** — a person, a place, a moment.
2. **Story** — who you are and why you're running.
3. **Stakes** — what's wrong and why it matters here.
4. **Vision** — the future you're fighting for.
5. **Ask** — what you need from them, today.

Draft

[HOOK] "Last week I sat at a kitchen table in [TOWN] with [NAME], who works [JOB] and still can't get ahead. Her question was simple: *Why does everything cost more, but my paycheck buys less?* I'm running for Congress because that question deserves an answer — and a fight."

[STORY] "I'm not a politician. I spent [#] years as a public-school teacher, and I've run a small business right here in [COUNTY]. I've made payroll, I've graded papers past midnight, and I've watched this community give everything it has. I'm running because the people who do the work deserve a representative who does theirs."

[STAKES] "Here's what's at stake. Families are squeezed by the cost of living. Our schools are asked to do more with less. And folks who paid into Social Security and Medicare their whole lives are told to just hope it's there. That's not a partisan complaint — it's a description of [DISTRICT] right now."

[VISION] "I believe in three things, plainly: **Lower the cost of living** so work pays again. **Fund our public schools** so every kid gets a real shot. **Protect Social Security and Medicare** — a promise made is a promise kept. That's the whole platform. No slogans you have to decode."

[ASK] "But I can't do this alone. I need you — tonight. Knock on ten doors. Bring five neighbors to the next event. Chip in what you can. If everyone in this room does one thing, we win. Are you with me?"

Delivery Notes

- **Pace:** slow down on the ask. Let silence do work.

- **Eye contact:** find three faces, return to them.
- **Cut on the fly:** if you're over time, drop the Stakes detail, never the Story or Ask.
- **Localize:** always name the town you're standing in.

Variants

Length	Use	Keep
30 sec	Elevator / rope line	Hook + Ask
2 min	Forum opening	Story + Vision + Ask
5–7 min	Stump / house party	Full arc